

Exercises, Lecture #2

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I Characteristic 0 singularities

1. Recall we blew up the origin in $\operatorname{Spec} k[x, y, z]/(x^4 + y^4 + z^4)$ to obtain Y . Verify that $H^1(Y, \mathcal{O}_Y) \neq 0$ by a direct computation and hence conclude that $k[x, y, z]/(x^4 + y^4 + z^4)$ does not have rational singularities.
2. Compute a log resolution¹ of $(k[x, y], y^2 - x^3)$.
3. Use the fact that rational singularities have the derived splinter property to prove the following theorem of Boutout. If $\phi : R \hookrightarrow S$ is a map of integral domains of finite type over a field of characteristic 0 such that ϕ is split as a map R -modules. If S has rational singularities, prove that so does R .

¹Meaning the exceptional and the inverse of $V(f)$ are in simple normal crossings

4. We will prove *Kempf's criterion for rational singularities*. Namely, R , a domain of (essentially) finite type over a field of characteristic zero, has rational singularities if and only if the following two conditions hold:

- R is Cohen-Macaulay.
- For any (equivalently every) resolution of singularities $Y \rightarrow \operatorname{Spec} R$ we have $\Gamma(Y, \omega_Y) = \omega_R$ (here ω_R is a canonical module² and $\omega_Y = \bigwedge^{\dim Y} \Omega_{Y/k}^1$).

Prove Kempf's criterion using the following two theorems.

- (a) Grothendieck duality over a Cohen-Macaulay ring.

$$\mathbf{R}\Gamma(Y, \mathbf{R}\mathcal{H}om_Y(F, \omega_Y)) \cong \mathbf{R}\operatorname{Hom}_R(\mathbf{R}\Gamma(Y, F), \omega_R)$$

where F is a coherent sheaf on Y .

- (b) Grauert-Riemenschneider vanishing. $H^i(Y, \omega_Y) = 0$ for all $i > 0$.

5. Prove that regular rings of finite type over a field of characteristic zero have rational singularities. You may use without proof that if $\pi : Y \rightarrow X$ is a proper birational map between Noetherian non-singular varieties, then $K_Y - \pi^* K_X$ has non-negative coefficients.³

²if $R = S/I$ where S is a polynomial ring, or localization thereof, then $\omega_R \cong \operatorname{Ext}^{\dim S - \dim R}(R, S)$

³For a challenge, prove this directly.

II Macaulay2 exercises

Remember, you can run Macaulay2 online using the two links below if you don't have it installed on your computer.

- Macaulay2 at Georgia Tech
- Macaulay2 at University of Melbourne

II.1 Blowups and cohomology

You can compute cohomology of a blowup in Macaulay2. Try running the following code.

```
needsPackage "BGG"
S = QQ[x,y,z]
f = x^2+y*z
m = ideal(x,y,z)
T = reesAlgebra m
A = ambient T
J = saturate(ideal(sub(f, T)), sub(m, T))
N = A^1/((ideal T) + sub(J, A))
C = directImageComplex N
```

The complex C above is the complex $\mathbf{R}\Gamma(Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ we saw in the lecture. Note J is the ideal defining the strict transform in the blowup. We had to go to the ambient because that's how the package **BGG** likes it. You can compute C 's cohomology in each degree by the following.

```
HH^0(C)
HH^1(C)
HH^2(C)
ann HH^0(C)
ann HH^1(C)
degree HH^1(C)
```

The command **ann** computes the annihilator. The command **degree** computes the length of a finite length module.

1. Verify that $x^2 + y * z$ defines rational singularities in Macaulay2.
2. Verify that $x^3 + y^3 + z^3$ and $x^4 + y^4 + z^4$ define non-rational singularities.
3. Find the limits of this package.

II.2 Packages for working with singularities in char 0

Run the following commands after you **restart**:

```
needsPackage "BernsteinSato"
R = QQ[x,y,z]
f = x^3+y^4+z^5
```

You can then run the following to decide if $R/(f)$ has rational singularities or to compute the log canonical threshold (lct).

```
hasRationalSing({f})
lct(ideal(f))
```

The function `hasRationalSing` is passed a list of generators of an ideal and it decides if the quotient has rational singularities. It only works if the list makes up a regular sequence. It is worth noting that these computations are *not* done by computing resolutions of singularities. These are done via D -module techniques.

II.3 Exercises

4. Do some experiments to make a prediction of what the lct of

$$x_1^{a_1} + \cdots + x_n^{a_n}$$

is. (At least if you don't already know the answer).

5. Compare the speed of determining whether a hypersurface has rational singularities in characteristic 0 or is F-regular in characteristic $p > 0$. You might find the command `elapsedTime` useful. As in

```
elapsedTime hasRationalSing({f})
elapsedTime isFRegular(R/ideal(g))
```

Note `random(3, R)` makes a random element of degree 3 in a polynomial ring.

6. How does the speed of computing F-regularity change as one increases the characteristic?